MONTHLY UPDATE

Energy: monthly update, August 2026

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> *21 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.*

BOTSWANA · BURUNDI · CENTRAL AFRICAN REPUBLIC · CHAD · COMOROS · ETHIOPIA · GAMBIA · GHANA · KENYA · LESOTHO · LIBYA · MADAGASCAR · MALAWI · MAURITIUS · MOZAMBIQUE · SIERRA LEONE · SOUTH AFRICA · SOUTH SUDAN · UGANDA · ZAMBIA · ZIMBABWE

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Botswana

The facility's power is the unusual part. On-site gas-fired generation is supplemented by solar introduced to cover periods of lower gas availability, with battery and compressed-gas storage under review — solar specified as firming for gas, the reverse of the usual diesel-backup arrangement. An initial 5 MW solar development was assessed during the quarter and an extension of the gas gathering network to connect a further production well is stated subject to funding; neither carries a capital cost, approval or date, and the company states both are work-programme items rather than guidance. The second gates the data centre: capacity growth turns on upstream gas work rather than on demand.

The price of the energy the sector runs on is under review, and the utility's own case is a large one: its consultation paper makes the case for a 46% tariff rise on a P9.585bn revenue requirement against a P3.477bn funding gap. It is an application rather than a determination: no regulator decision, effective date or data-centre tariff schedule accompanies it, and the base still holds no measured electricity cost for any digital facility in the country.

Burundi

Among the regulator's remedies for degraded service, named on 3 August, is a planned study on powering mobile base stations.

Central African Republic

The power the digital estate runs on moved more this month than the estate did. A 50MW solar plant with 15MWh of battery storage was inaugurated on 12 August, reported to raise national generation capacity by over 60% and to strengthen grid stability.

Against a baseline of 28MW installed and 16 to 18 hours of daily load-shedding, that is the largest single change on this ledger. What is not published is any post-commissioning figure: no availability, no load-shedding hours and no connection count, so the capacity is stated and its effect is not.

Chad

The grid the digital estate sits on went backwards. After a fire at the Farcha thermal plant in late July, load-shedding in parts of N'Djamena had run close to a month by 20 August, the utility saying the burnt sets need new equipment and giving no date. The data centre awaiting certification and the government network both sit on that supply, and no power arrangement for either is held.

Comoros

The thermal plant on Mwali was down to 1,000 litres of diesel a day against a stated requirement of 7,000, with a total blackout feared on 4 August. The island has no fuel depot sized to its needs and depends on maritime resupply, and the account records repeated earlier ruptures in the same year. It is the first measured figure for fuel supply to any island's generation in the base.

Ethiopia

The incumbent's renewable programme reached 39.72 MW of installed solar across 190 fully solar-powered sites, 867 hybrid systems and 1,114 lithium-ion storage units, 12.72 MW of it added over the financial year, with diesel generator running time down by up to 40%. The figures are the operator's own and unaudited.

Gambia

The power the digital estate runs on was explained and priced in the same month. The utility put the year's worst outages down to ageing generating units and spare parts taking six to seven months to import, promising relief within a fortnight; a lender's public finance review puts tariffs at an average US$0.21 a kilowatt-hour, among the highest globally, driven by weak utility financial performance with subsidies found misdirected. The target above both is now traceable to its instrument: a draft national compact seeking US$552m to reach 100% access by 2030, unsigned and unfunded.

Ghana

The transmission system failed nationally twice in three weeks. A major fault on the Akosombo-Volta line at about 4.30am on 20 August tripped the Akosombo units and some thermal plants, three weeks after a system disturbance at about 3.11am on 29 July had tripped generating plants simultaneously. The operator opened a technical investigation into the first and said further measures were needed to strengthen reliability after the second; no interruption index is published for either.

On 28 August the energy ministry launched a GHS598 million project to connect 206 communities across all 18 districts of the Volta Region within six months, part of a programme covering four regions this year and four more annually to 2030. It is the largest funded rural-electrification commitment the base holds, and it lands in the same month as the second national outage.

Kenya

The distributor put a limit on the energy transition in public. On 11 August KPLC urged that the quantum of variable renewable generation coming onto the system be moderated to protect grid stability. It is a statement of position rather than a curtailment rule, a connection standard or a published limit, and nothing in the base says what quantum the utility considers safe. A week earlier the Senate energy committee received a status report on the off-grid solar access project and asked for assurances that it is delivering. The data-centre load the grid is being built to carry remains unmeasured in this ledger.

Lesotho

The electricity corporation states it has held supply availability above 99 per cent on the transmission network and around 95 per cent on distribution for the past years, attributing the faults that remain to an ageing network and to weather. The figures are the utility's own and the base holds nothing that tests them.

Libya

The utility fired the first of four units at a new South Tripoli plant on 28 August, toward 1,320 MW of added capacity. It follows a failure in July that lost 1,350 MW and darkened most of the country, blamed on a tripped 400kV line. The standing policy for Libyan data centres asks for 99.9 per cent power uptime and twenty-four hours of fuel.

Madagascar

Power went the wrong way in the last week of August. A defective circuit breaker on the TAC 1 turbine at Ambohimanambola forced JIRAMA to halt production and impose rotating load-shedding across the Antananarivo interconnected network on 29 August, a first repair attempt having failed and the unit having been dismantled for emergency inspection. Two weeks earlier the World Bank had reported the Toamasina rebuild after February's cyclone, with about 4 MW still offline and load-shedding continuing. The state data centres commissioned this year sit on the same network, and nothing published states their load.

Malawi

The generator's own account of 22 August records reduced hydropower generation across several stations with remediation timelines running on. It follows the commissioning in July of the country's first standalone utility-scale battery storage system, 20 megawatts and 40 megawatt-hours at Kanengo, returning about 100 megawatts of previously curtailed renewable capacity to use. Storage was added in the same quarter generation fell.

Mauritius

Cabinet also approved for signature a memorandum with Saudi Arabia putting digital transformation and energy-sector cybersecurity alongside hydrocarbons — an approval to sign, not a signature, with no date, term, value or committed system stated.

Mozambique

The same data centre draws on grid, photovoltaic and generator supply (inauguration account).

Sierra Leone

The constraint under everything else eased slightly. A World Bank-funded 40MW solar-plus-storage project at Lungi and Newton became fully operational, commissioned in July 2026 and projected to raise the electricity access rate toward 36% and to ease the outages that interrupt telecommunications and digital services. The access projection is the project's own; no generation outturn, grid-availability series or measured effect on network uptime is held, so the connection between the plant and the services it is said to protect is asserted rather than shown.

South Africa

The grid had its best month on the utility's own reporting in six years. Eskom put the energy availability factor at 67.55%, its highest in six years, with unplanned outages down 44.5% year on year, about 1.2 million customers removed from load reduction and 505,607 smart meters installed, the Eastern Cape becoming the seventh province removed from load reduction. These are the utility's figures and no regulator or system-operator confirmation accompanies them.

It closes a build programme rather than opening one: the last unit of the two flagship stations entered commercial operation in September 2025, adding 800 MW. What the month does not settle is adequacy after 2029, which the system operator's own assessment identifies as the risk and which is carried in the progress report rather than here.

South Sudan

Two connections completed in one week. A project connecting more than 400 customers in the border town of Nimule on imported Ugandan power launched on 15 August, and two days later government and a development agency handed over a 150 kWp solar plant with 200 kWh of battery storage giving continuous power to the Aweil Regional Reference Laboratory in Northern Bahr el Ghazal.

The larger supply picture moved too: the energy minister reported on 18 August that transmission works are advancing to bring Ugandan hydropower to Juba through Nimule, with a distribution substation already built at Nesitu. Against a rural population almost entirely unserved, four hundred customers is the scale of what completed.

Uganda

The largest operator's 2025 sustainability report puts 45% of network sites on solar or hydro, with a 490 kWh solar plant commissioned at headquarters. The figures are the company's own and unaudited, and no prior-year share is held against which to read that share.

Zambia

Power at the tower is where a network's reliability is decided, and one operator put money against it. The tower company INFRATEL says it has invested US$5 million in power resilience at mobile sites, deploying high-powered thermal batteries and upgrading solar plant. The figure is the company's own; no site count, no before-and-after outage measure and no independent verification is in the record held.

Zimbabwe

The listed infrastructure company commenced phase 1 of a 100 MW solar farm for its technology park, and its fuel-management system was credited with reducing energy consumption on tower sites, with no percentage, litre, cost or uptime figure given (trading update).

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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